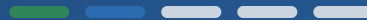


ADO Usage (Hands-On)

Week 7 • Day 2 • Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery

TPM Academy



Day 2 Objectives

- Use the **4-level hierarchy** (Epic → Feature → User Story → Task) without going deeper
- Apply **field discipline** to every work item
- Estimate with **story points**; split anything >13
- Build the **5 essential queries** + sprint board + Kanban board
- Read the **3 standard charts**: cumulative flow diagram (CFD), burn-down, velocity
- Use AI as a **standup-prep aid** — with validation



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	ADO access check; pin DP Section 1
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Build the hierarchy
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Field discipline + Tasks
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	Queries + Boards
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Charts + AI standup aid

Block 1 — The 4-Level Hierarchy

Epic → Feature → User Story → Task



ADO Vocabulary

These terms recur all day — including Work Item Query Language (WIQL), the query syntax.

Term	What it is
Work item	The atomic unit (Epic, Feature, User Story, Task, Bug)
Hierarchy	Epic → Feature → User Story → Task
Area path	Logical product area
Iteration path	Sprint / time window
State	New / Active / Resolved / Closed
Tags	Free-form labels for cross-cutting filters
Story points	Effort estimate (Fibonacci: 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13)
WIQL	Query language; saves filters



The Hierarchy in Practice

```
Epic – strategic theme; ~1 per quarterly initiative
├── Feature – deliverable slice; 1-3 per Epic
│   ├── User Story – user-visible value
│   │   ├── Task – engineering / design / TPM work
│   │   └── User Story
│   │       └── Task
│   └── Feature
```

Don't go deeper than 4 levels. Don't promote a Task to a User Story to "make it visible."



For Your Academy Feature

- **1 Epic** — broader theme (e.g., "Reduce dispatcher after-shift admin load")
- **1 Feature** — your Product Requirements Document (PRD) (e.g., "Reconcile flow")
- **5–10 User Stories** — each acceptance criteria (AC) roughly maps to one
- **2–4 Tasks per User Story** — Build / Test / Document / Review

Non-functional requirements (NFRs) from PRD Section 7 / Technical Concept Document (TCD) Section 3 Section 4 are work too. They get their own User Stories tagged non-functional.

Activity 1 — Build the Hierarchy

Quads • 45 minutes

- 5 min: define the Epic (title + description + tags)
- 5 min: define the Feature (parent: Epic)
- 15 min: 5–10 User Stories from PRD Section 6 ACs
- 10 min: NFR stories tagged non-functional



5 + 5 + 15 + 10

Block 2 — Field Discipline + Tasks

Title alone is not enough



Required Fields per Work Item

Field	Why it matters
Title	Clear, action-oriented
Description	1-paragraph context
Acceptance Criteria	From PRD Section 6; testable
Story Points	Effort estimate (User Stories only)
State	Workflow visibility
Area path	Reporting hierarchy
Iteration path	Sprint scheduling
Tags	Cross-cutting filters
Linked work items	Parent / child / related

Cost of skipping fields: sprint review where nobody can find anything.



Story Points (Fibonacci)

- 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13 — standard sequence
- Use **planning poker**: each member estimates silently, then reveals. Discuss; don't average.
- Stories **>13 points** are too vague to estimate. Split.

Story points are a **learning tool** even when imperfect. Don't skip because "we don't really estimate."



Tasks — Verb-First, Specific

For each User Story, draft 2–4 Tasks. Common pattern:

- **Build** — the implementation work
- **Test** — automated test coverage
- **Document** — release notes, internal docs
- **Review** — security, peer, stakeholder sign-off

Task title test: "Build Reconcile API endpoint" beats "API work." Verb-first; specific.

Activity 2 — Field Discipline + Tasks

Quads • 50 minutes

- 15 min: field pass on every work item
- 10 min: story-point estimation (planning poker)
- 15 min: 2–4 Tasks per User Story



15 + 10 + 15

Block 3 — Queries + Boards

The 5 every team needs



The 5 Essential Queries

Query	When to run
Open in current sprint	Every standup
Blocked	Daily
Done in this sprint	End-of-sprint review
Stale (no movement > N days)	Weekly
Open NFRs / quality / compliance	Monthly

Save them in a shared folder. Name them clearly. They become the team's heartbeat.



Sprint Board + Kanban Board

Sprint board

- Filtered to current iteration
- Daily-standup view
- Columns: To Do / In Progress / In Review / Done

Feature Kanban

- Whole feature, not one sprint
- Same columns
- Used for cross-sprint planning

Set WIP limits explicitly (e.g., max 3 In Progress per developer). They are a forcing function.

Activity 3 — Queries + Boards

Quads • 50 minutes

- 15 min: build all 5 queries
- 10 min: configure sprint board with WIP limits
- 10 min: configure Feature Kanban
- 5 min: identify the daily-driver query



15 + 10 + 10 + 5

Block 4 — Reading the Charts + AI

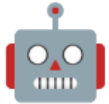
CFD / burn-down / velocity, then AI as standup aid



The 3 Standard Charts

Chart	What it tells you
Cumulative Flow Diagram	Where work is queuing; cycle time; WIP bloat
Burn-down	On-track for end of sprint; scope creep
Velocity	Capacity over time; team-health signals

Watch: declining velocity is a flag for burnout, blockers, or context-switching. Investigate before pushing harder.



AI as Standup-Prep Aid

```
Role: Standup-prep assistant for a TPM.  
Context: <yesterday's ADO query results – items moved state,  
items added, items closed, comments added>  
Task: Produce a 5-bullet standup summary:  
1. Top 2 things shipped  
2. Top 2 things blocked or stuck (>2 days no movement)  
3. 1 anomaly (pattern unusual for this team)  
Constraints:  
- Use only the provided data  
- Flag anything you can't determine  
Format: 5 numbered bullets, each <15 words.
```

Validation discipline: cross-check claims against actual Azure DevOps (ADO) data. Same Wk 5 D5 rule.

Activity 4 — Charts + AI Aid

Quads • 55 minutes • Wrap

- 15 min: walk the 3 charts; what would you look for?
- 10 min: run AI standup-prep prompt
- 10 min: validate output
- 10 min: document Section 2 with links / screenshots



15 + 10 + 10 + 10 • 15-min wrap



Day 2 Wrap

What we built

- 4-level hierarchy (Epic/Feature/Story/Task)
- Field discipline applied
- Story points + Tasks
- 5 essential queries
- Sprint board + Kanban with WIP limits
- Charts read; AI standup pattern
- Delivery Plan (DP) Section 2 drafted

What opens tomorrow

- **Outcome-based vs output-based tracking**
- Tracking plan: output / outcome / leading indicator
- Sprint cadence; dashboards

Bring to Day 3: Loaded ADO + DP Section 2. Tomorrow we wire tracking on top.

Questions & Reflection

Which work item in your backlog is most likely to get forgotten?